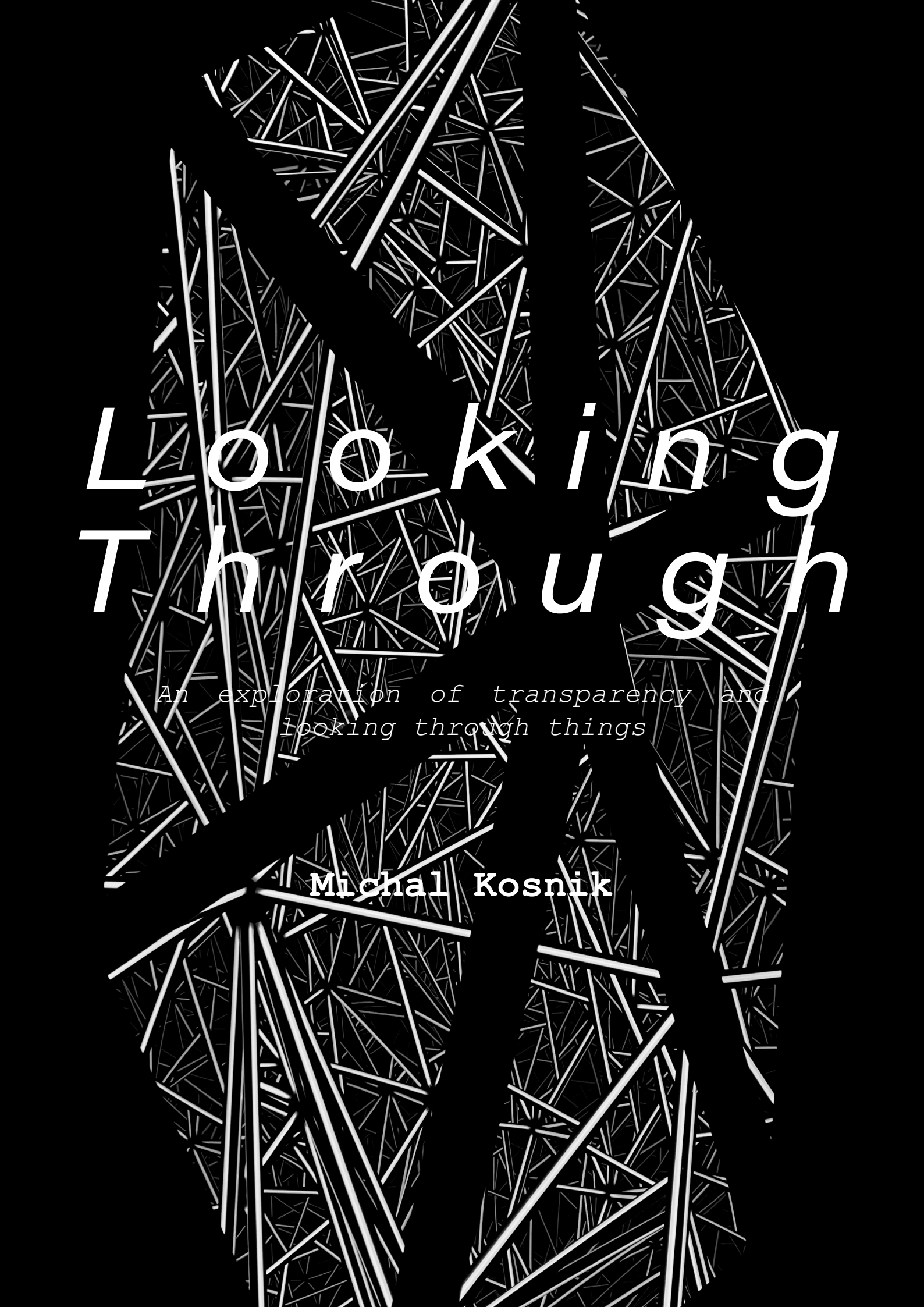


The background of the entire image is a dense, chaotic pattern of thin, white, diagonal and horizontal lines of varying lengths and orientations, creating a textured, almost crystalline or fibrous appearance against a solid black background.

Looking Through

*An exploration of transparency and
looking through things*

Michal Kosnik

This collection of photographs aims to explore the idea of transparency, translucency and opacity, and what it means to look through 'see-through' media in order to see whats on the other side- as well as some visual effects that can happen as a result of doing so.

The photos are roughly in order of how abstractly this notion is interpreted.

Usual transparent objects, like a window or a glass of water, will allow light to pass through relatively clearly, allowing you to see what is on the other side of them.

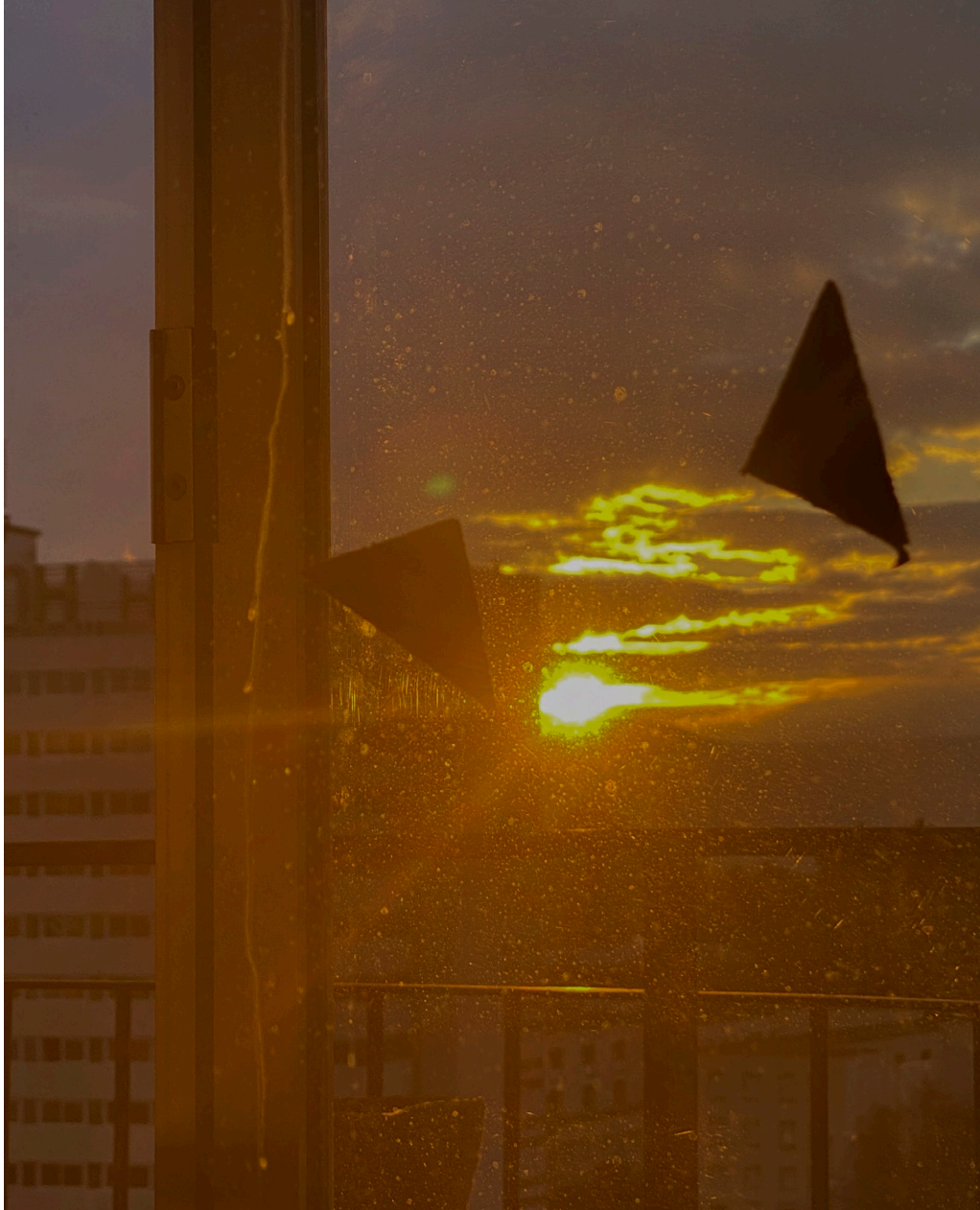
Sometimes the 'see-through' object is in fact only semi-transparent, or translucent, and obscures or distorts the object on the other side in one way or another.

Other times, an object between the viewer and another object isn't transparent or translucent at all, yet we can still 'see through' it- for example when the intermediary object is not solid.

This results in two opaque objects, one in front of the other, that are both within our view- this can create a harmonious visual relationship between the two.

This compilation is a visual investigation, and at times, an attempt to push the boundaries of what it means to look, or see, through objects of different levels of opacity. This can be interpreted as a relationship between foreground and background.

All photos have been subject to varying levels of minor colour grading, cropping and straightening in Lightroom- other adjustments and camera setting changes are mentioned in the description when applicable



ISO20

82mm

f2

1/232s

iPhone11Pro

This photo was taken after our window panes were replaced in our flat, and these cork triangles were left on the glass. The sunset shines through the dirty window, highlighting the streaks and spots (the camera is focused on this, highlighting it further), and the triangular silhouettes are seemingly floating mid-air and blocking the sunlight.



ISO125

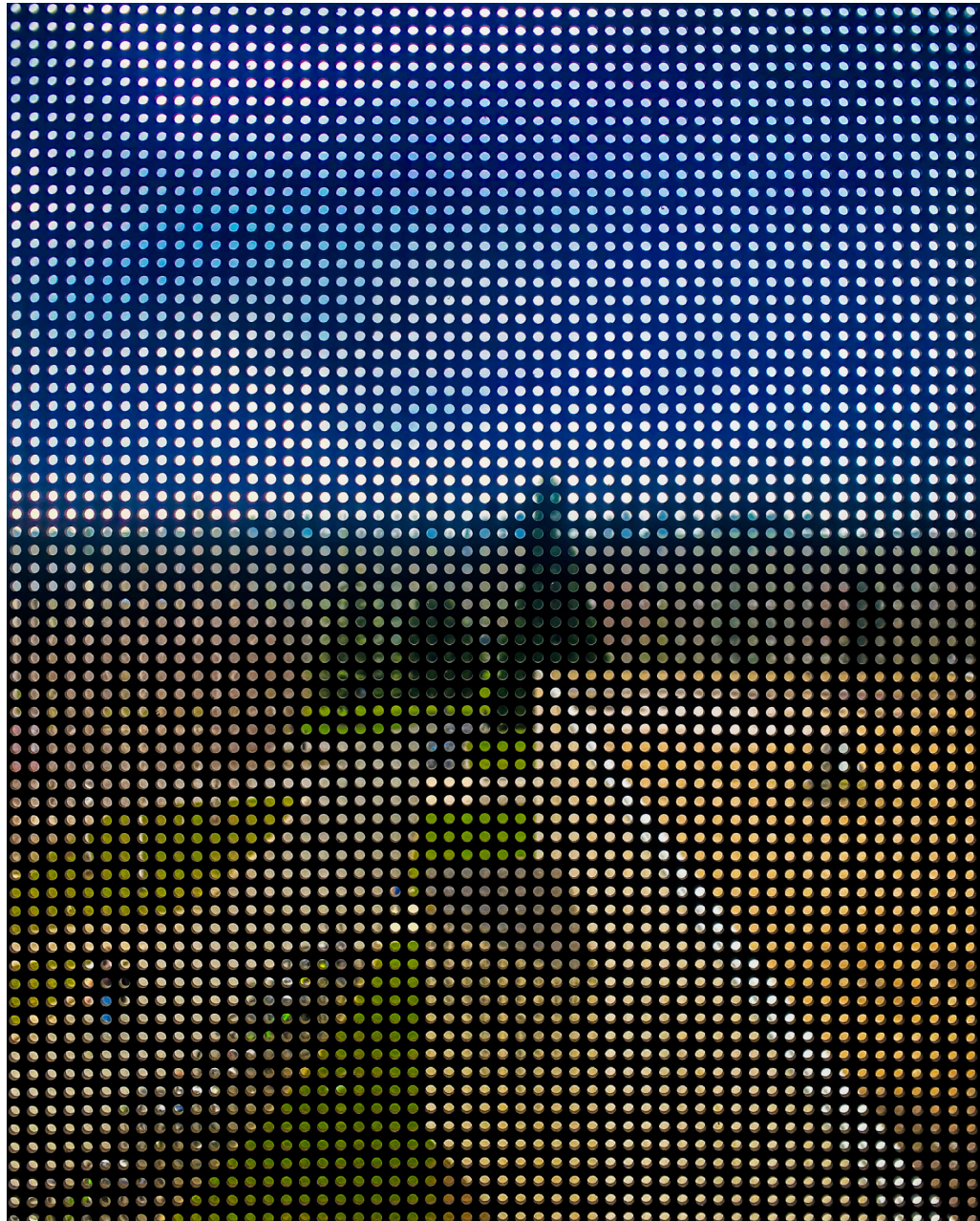
26mm

f1.8

1/121s

iPhone11Pro

View through a bus window on a heavily rainy day, with the streaks of rain on the pane distorting the view in a semi-regular diagonal pattern- reminiscent of the style of an expressionist or impressionist painting.



ISO32

26mm

f1.8

1/1135s

iPhone11Pro

View of the University of Navarra campus from the second floor of the FCOM building- photograph is taken through a mesh pane, creating a 'pixellated' illusion. Looking at the photograph from further away, or squinting your eyes, reveals the landscape more clearly.



ISO20

52mm

f2

1/122s

iPhone11Pro

The smoke in the foreground is catching the sunlight from the window, and its' irregular patterns, swirls and wisps are illuminated by this direct light source- contrasting to the dark background of the unlit room it's in.



ISO250

26mm

f1.8

1/59s

iPhone11Pro

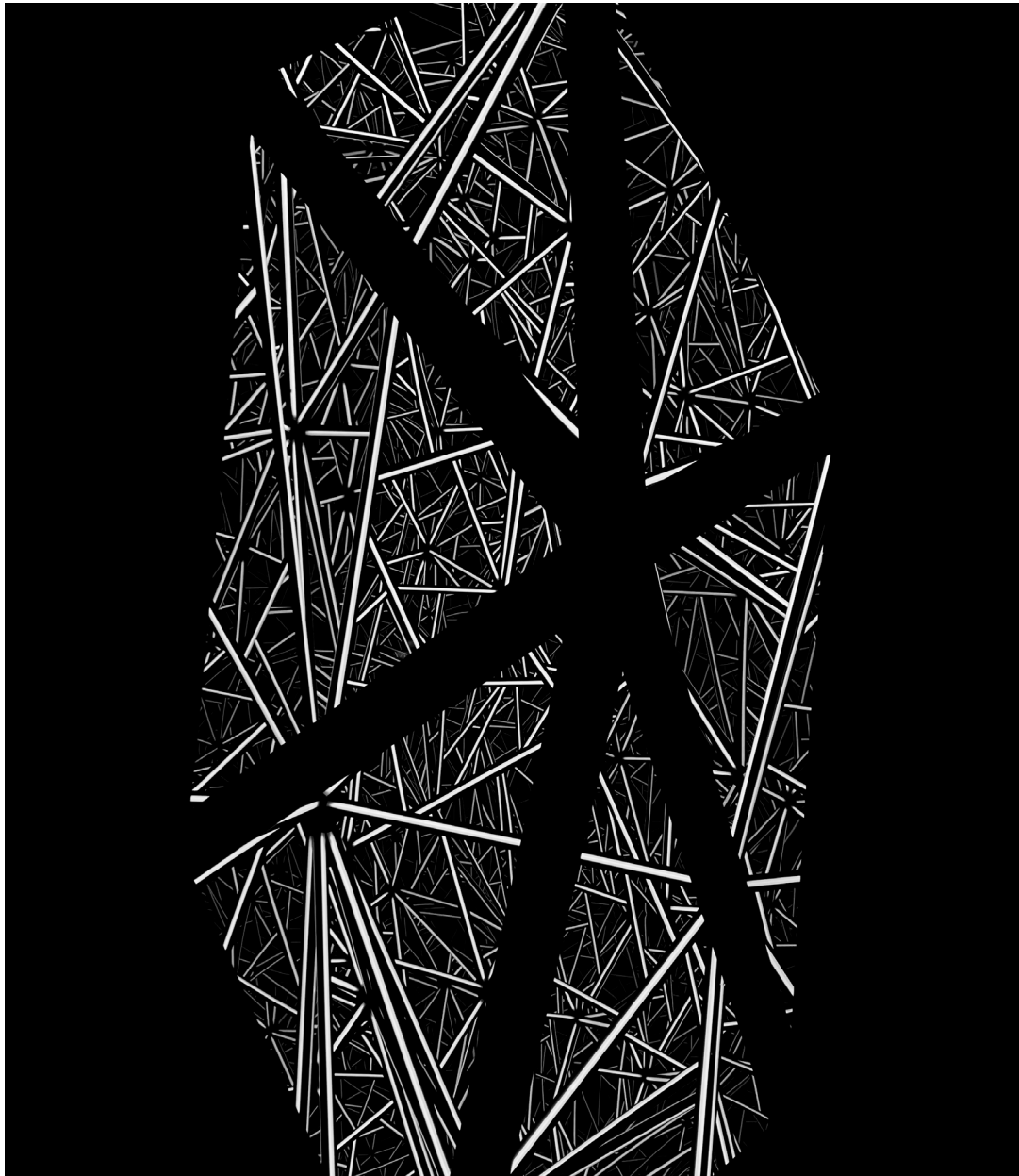
A macro photograph through the top of a crystal champagne flute, with the intricate crystal patterns diffracting the light coming from outside the flute, creating a kaleidoscopic effect. The focus is on the hexagonal bottom of the glass in the centre of the image, blurring the body of the glass around it, and emphasising the sense of depth as a result.



ISO250 26mm f1.8 1/59s iPhone11Pro

This photo was taken on my way home from a night out, and I noticed out of the corner of my eye the way the lamp acted as a backlight for this tree, which happened to create a near perfect halo around the lamp. The colder hue of the traffic lights in the background also nicely contrasts with the warm glow of the lamp.

-1.8 ev exposure



ISO40

27mm

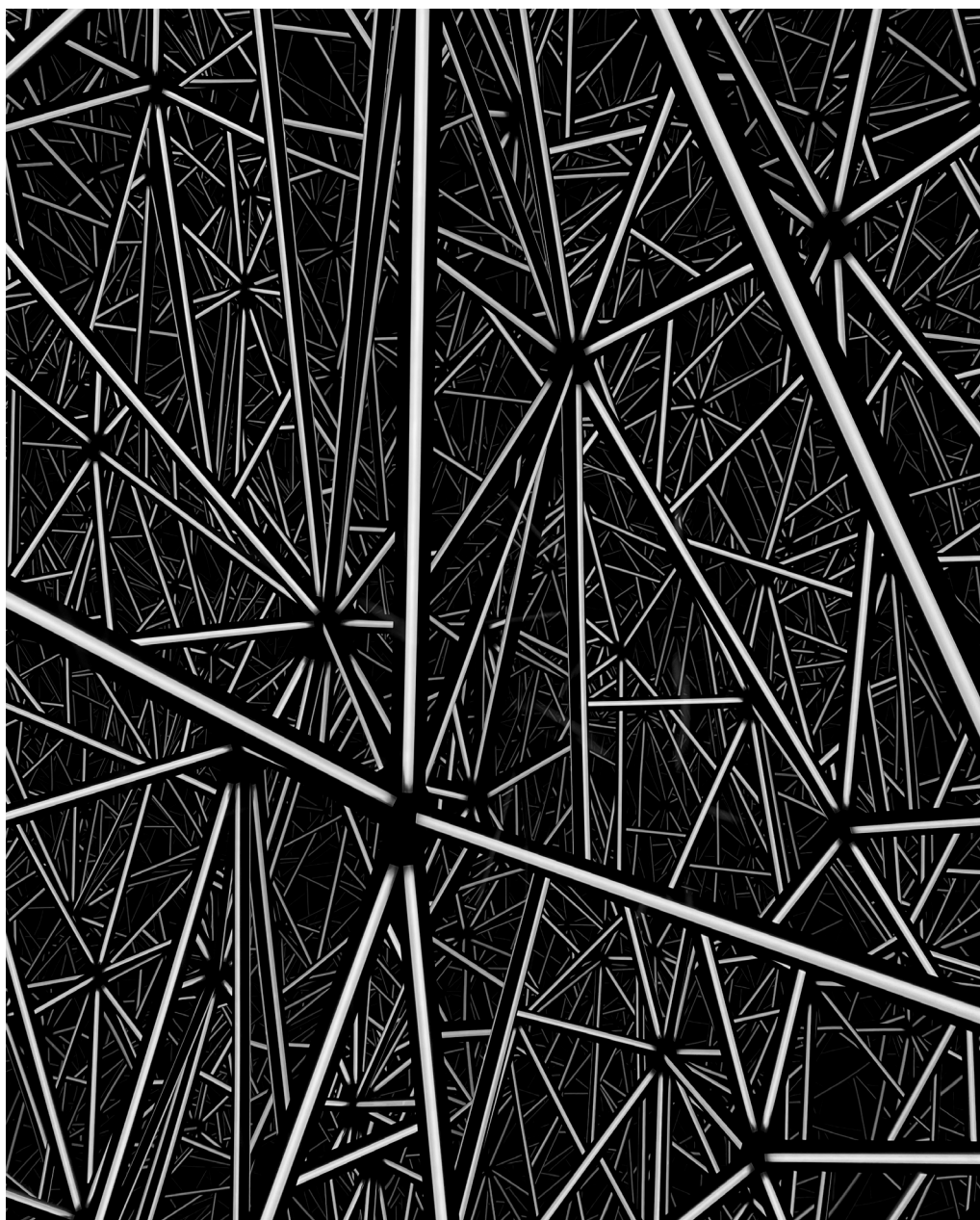
f1.8

1/122s

iPhone11Pro

These two photographs were taken at an Anthony James infinity mirror exhibition. His artworks are essentially glass boxes that you can look through, with specifically placed mirrors and lights inside that create this illusion of an infinite geometric world. This photo shows the shape of the box itself.

-2.3 ev exposure, greyscale filter



ISO50

26mm

f1.8

1/121s

iPhone11Pro

This photo shows a closer view of the inside of
Anthony James' artwork.

Greyscale filter



ISO160

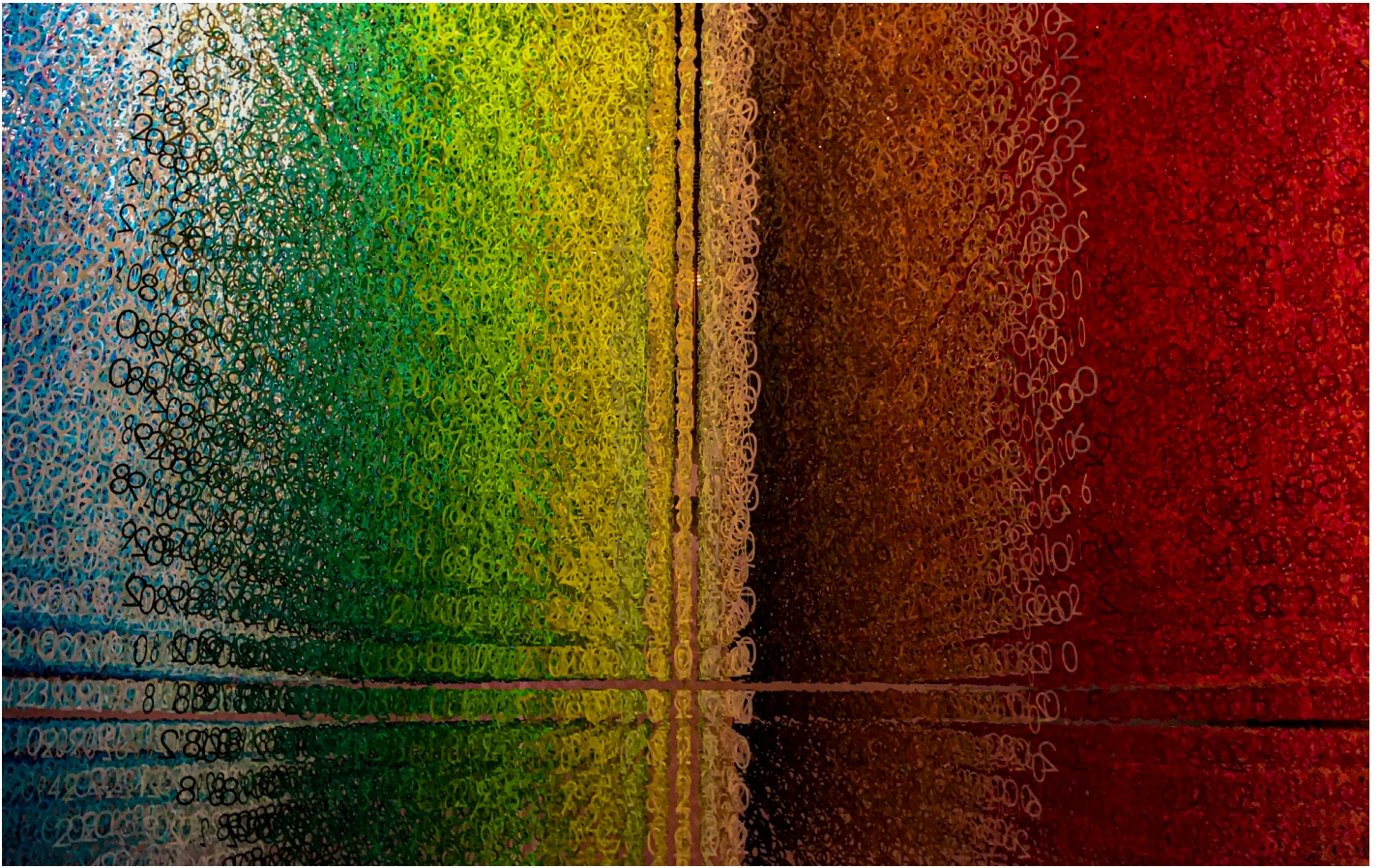
29mm

f2.2

1/33s

iPhone6s

These two are photographs taken of Emmanuelle Moureaux's '*Slices of Time*' exhibition. It is a room filled with cutouts of colourful numbers suspended in a grid pattern, and all the numbers are in order from zero to the current year- symbolising time passing. Here, you can see the green ones in the background through the layers of peach, pink and red coloured ones, creating a gradient.



ISO100

29mm

f2.2

1/33s

iPhone6s

This photo was taken at a direct 90 degree angle to one of the 'slices', which reveals the grid pattern- in this one, you can see through the gaps between the slices perpendicular to the camera, which create a cross shape in the centre.



ISO1000

26mm

f1.8

1/20s

iPhone11Pro

This photograph was taken on a particularly foggy winter morning, when the visibility was very low and it was still relatively dark outside. The fog is diffracting and softening the glow of the lamps, as well as obscuring the view of the rest of the landscape. Overall this creates an almost ethereal atmosphere.



ISO125

14mm

f2.4

1/121s

iPhone11Pro

This is a photograph looking up through the Shard in London. Perhaps a more abstract interpretation of the idea of 'looking through' things since transparency or opacity don't apply here, however we can still see through each floor to the top of the building in the centre of the photograph, thanks to the corners having cut-outs.



ISO32

51mm

f1.8

1/2755s

iPhone11Pro

Also a more abstract interpretation of the core idea- in this case the bees are 'looking through' the hole in the wall, instead of us as the viewers performing this action.

Additionally, thanks to the very fast shutter speed, the photograph manages to capture the right bee's translucent wing while mid-flight, making it appear oddly still.